

Mexico

Ratio: 4:7 **Adopted:** November 2, 1821 **Usage:** National and Civil

The basic design is derived from the French *Tricolore*



Red, white, and green are the colors of the national liberation army in Mexico

The coat of arms incorporates the badge of Mexico City

North America



Mexico was conquered by Spain in the 16th century, but broke away in 1821 to form a Central American state. It became a republic in 1822.

France was the inspiration of those who detached Mexico from Spain in 1821 and they devised a new tricolor based on the flag of the liberation army. At that time the Italian tricolor was not in use.

The coat of arms on the center stripe distinguishes the flag from that of Italy.

THE AZTEC INHERITANCE

The central emblem is the Aztec pictogram for Tenochtitlán (now Mexico City), the center of their empire. It recalls the legend which inspired the Aztecs to settle on what was originally a lake-island.

The form of the coat of arms was most recently revised in 1968.

ARMS OF MEXICO

The lake with an island, represents Tenochtitlán

Ribbon in the national colors



Aztec legend held that they should found their city on the spot where they saw an eagle on a cactus, eating a snake